Board Meeting

April 8, 2025

VANCOUVER PUBLIC SCHOOLS

Superintendent Report

VANCOUVER PUBLIC SCHOOLS

National Anthem

Fort Vancouver HS

Ben Bouton - Choir

National Anthem

Yo Le Canto Todo el Día

Superintendent Report

VANCOUVER PUBLIC SCHOOLS VPS

Federal Funding Update

Yesterday (4.3.25), the Office for Civil Rights within the U.S. Department of Education sent state education agencies (SEAs) a document titled "Reminder of Legal Obligations Undertaken in Exchange for Receiving Federal Financial Assistance and Request for Certification under Title VI and SFFA v. Harvard" and requested, ***within 10 days, a signed certification from the SEAs and local education agencies (LEAs) related to compliance with Title VI and SFFA v. Harvard****.*

Since receiving the request for certification, the OSPI team has been engaging with multiple state and national partners to understand the legality of the directive and our next steps.

It is OSPI's position that Washington LEAs, in alignment with our state and federal laws, are already in compliance with Title VI. OSPI has previously submitted the required assurances that our state will comply with federal law.

At this time, LEAs do not have any action steps related to this directive. Further communication with the Department of Education on this matter will be coordinated by OSPI.

OUR MISSION

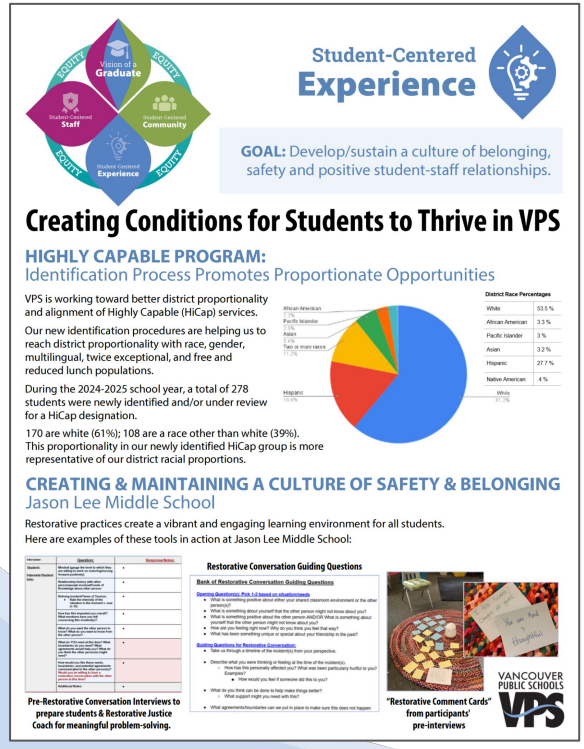
Inspiring Learning.

Growing Community.

Each student, Every day.

Monitoring Our Progress

Are our actions positively impacting the experience and learning?

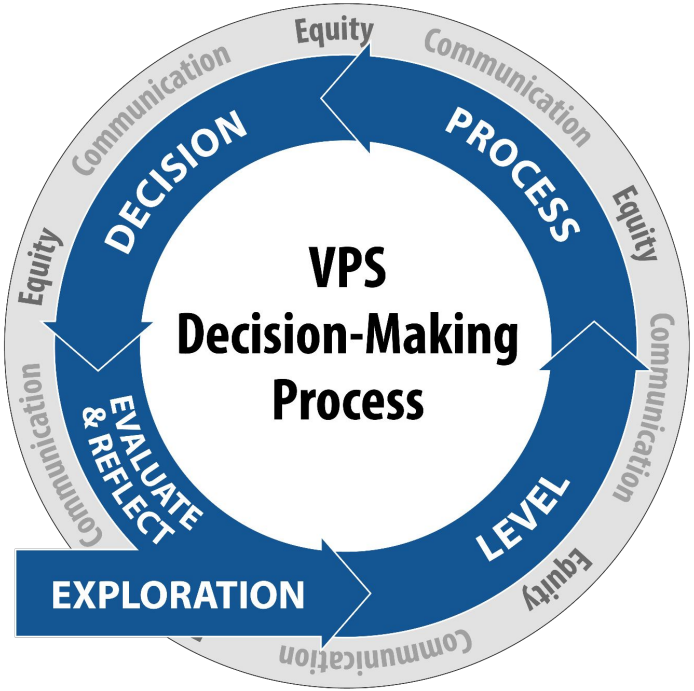


Scan to view

2025-26 Budget Development

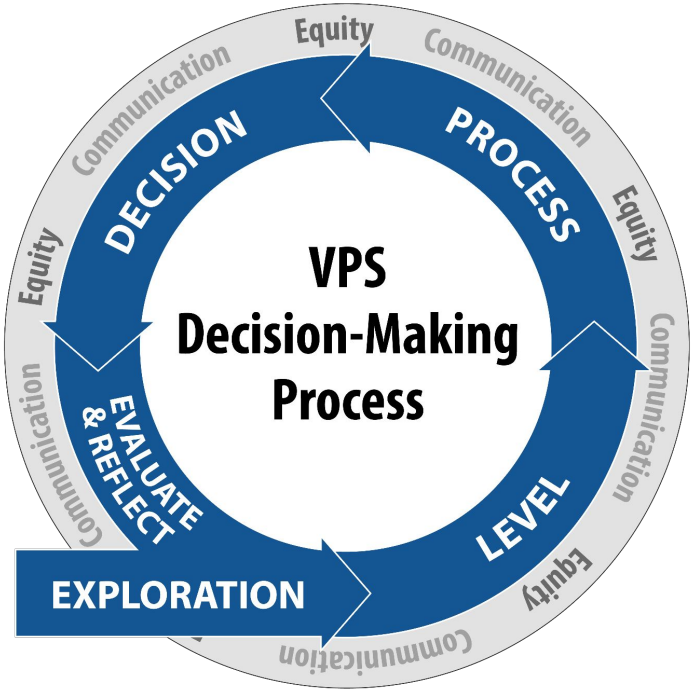
VANCOUVER PUBLIC SCHOOLS

2025-26 Budget Development Process



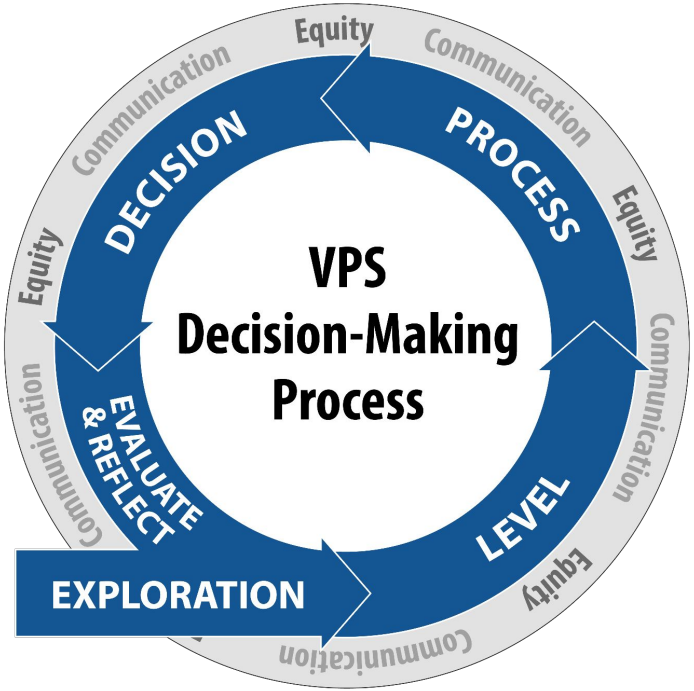
Timeline Overview

- March Board Meeting Overview
- Board Budget Committee ongoing
- April Board Meeting - Update on major variables
- April 27, 2025 - Legislative Sine Die
- April 29, 2025 - Workshop with Budget Committee on staffing recommendations
- May 2, 2025 - Release staffing to schools
- May Board Meeting - Summary recommendations to board
- July Board Meeting - Final recommendations, preview final budget outcomes
- August Board Meeting - Public hearing, final budget adoption



Exploration

Will the 25-26 budget realities be as bad as the 24-25 budget?



Exploration

Why didn’t we reduce enough last year to prevent the need to make reductions this year?

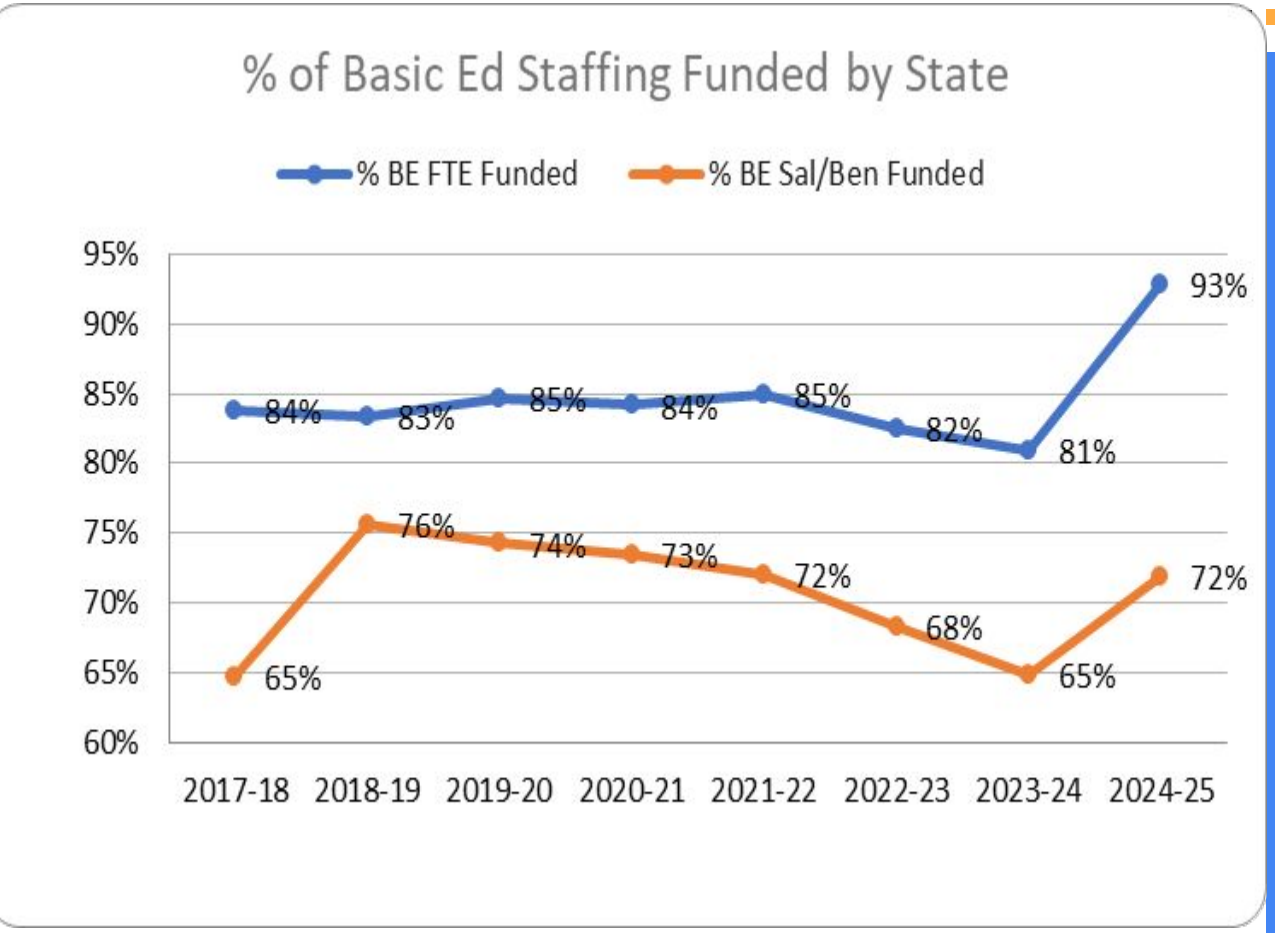
Exploration

- **Increased Basic Education Staffing Costs**
  - Gap between cost per staff member and funding from state
  - Gap between # of staff needed to operate and allocation from state

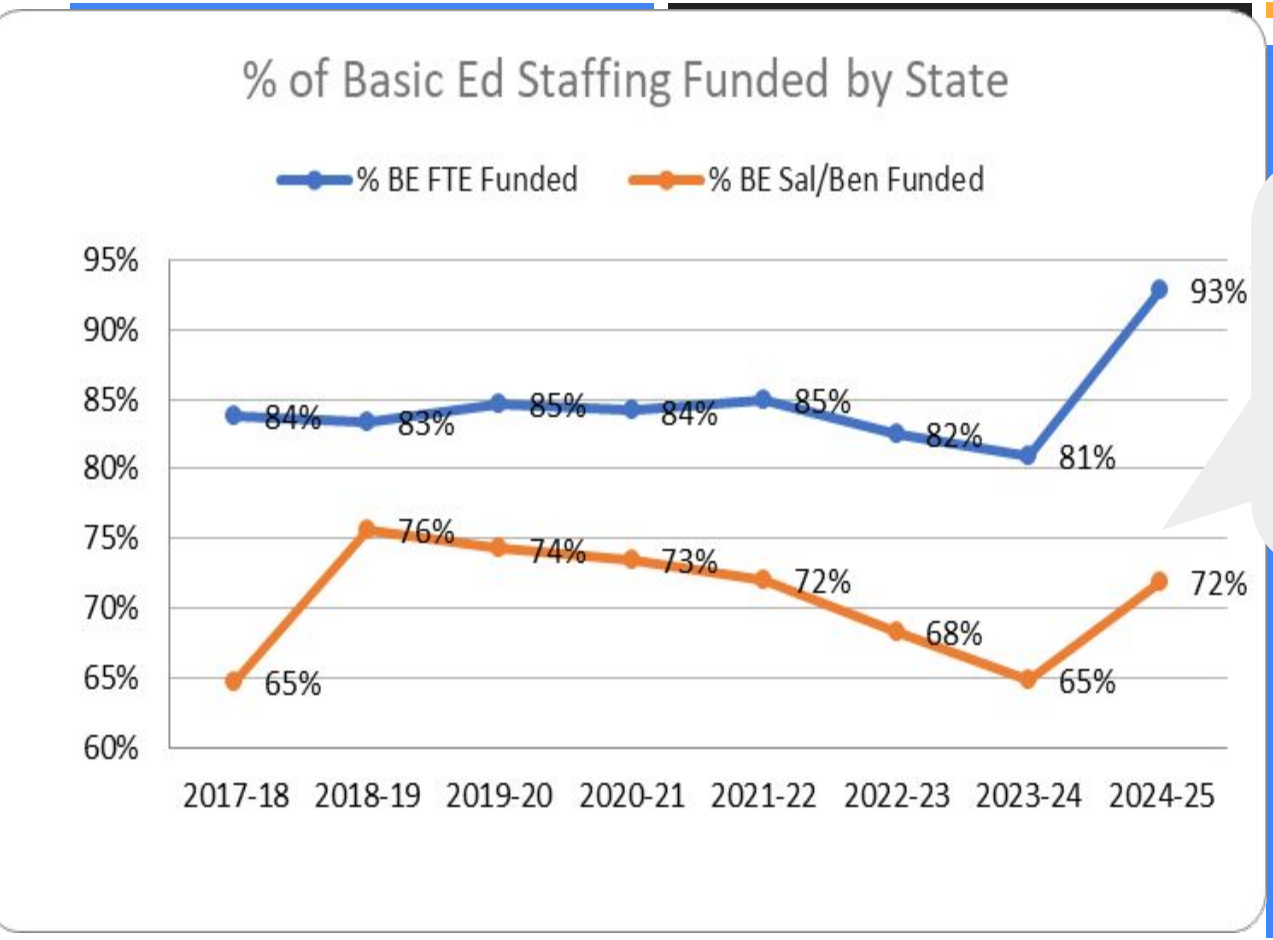
- **Increased Other Costs**
  - Increased Insurance and utilities costs
  - Special Education costs
  - Substitute costs
  - Transportation costs

- **Increased Student Need** - consistent feedback that more staff are needed

- **Student Enrollment** - overall decline since 2018, due to low than normal birth rates (graduating larger classes than incoming kindergarten cohorts)



VANCOUVER PUBLIC SCHOOLS FUNDING GAP FROM THE STATE



Has the staff significantly increased funding?

No, we reduced 247.5 full time equivalent staff positions.

THE STATE

Exploration

- **Variables Currently Known**:
  - Enrollment projected to be less than 24-25 projected final average (continuing to graduate larger classes than incoming kindergarten cohort)
  - “Right sizing” of teaching staff to occur through attrition, not Reduction in Force
  - Special Ed needs continue to expand
  - MSOC (particularly insurance, utilities) growing faster than traditional legislative inflation adj.
  - Open contracts for VAESP, SEIU, and VAPA

- **Variables Not Yet Known**:
  - Legislative funding improvement (Spec. Ed., MSOC, possibly levy equalization)
  - Federal funding impact
  - Fund balance targets

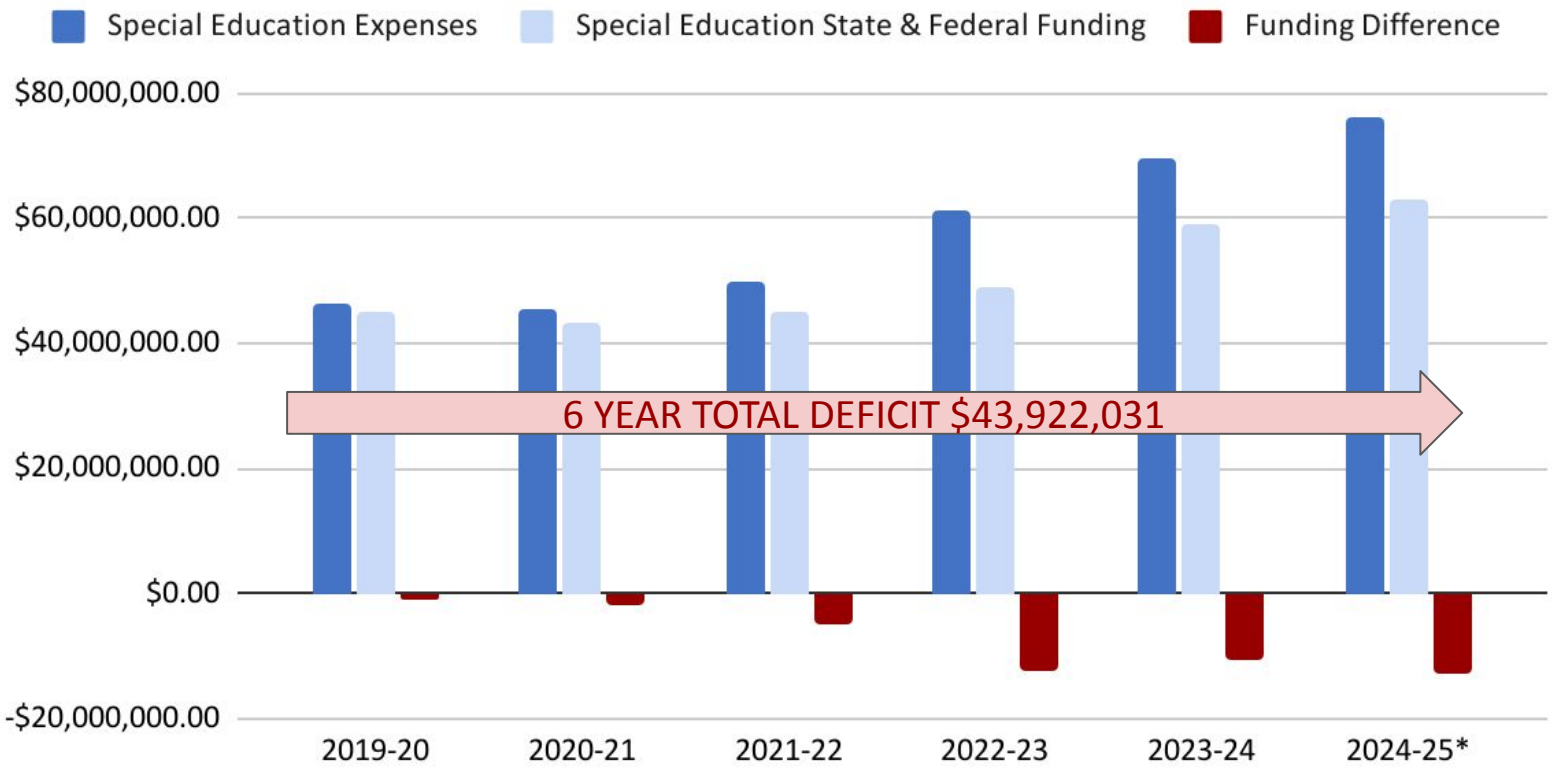
Special Education Trends

- More students are needing services and are qualifying through the IEP process
- State and federal funding is not matching local commitments to inclusionary practices
- Even in areas where state has increased funding, needs have grown faster than incremental funding
- Continue to rely on local levy funding to fill significant gaps

  <u>Prime examples:</u>

  - State caps any special ed funding at 16% of student body
  - Even for students qualifying for safety net, districts must spend more than twice traditional state funding before safety net kicks in.

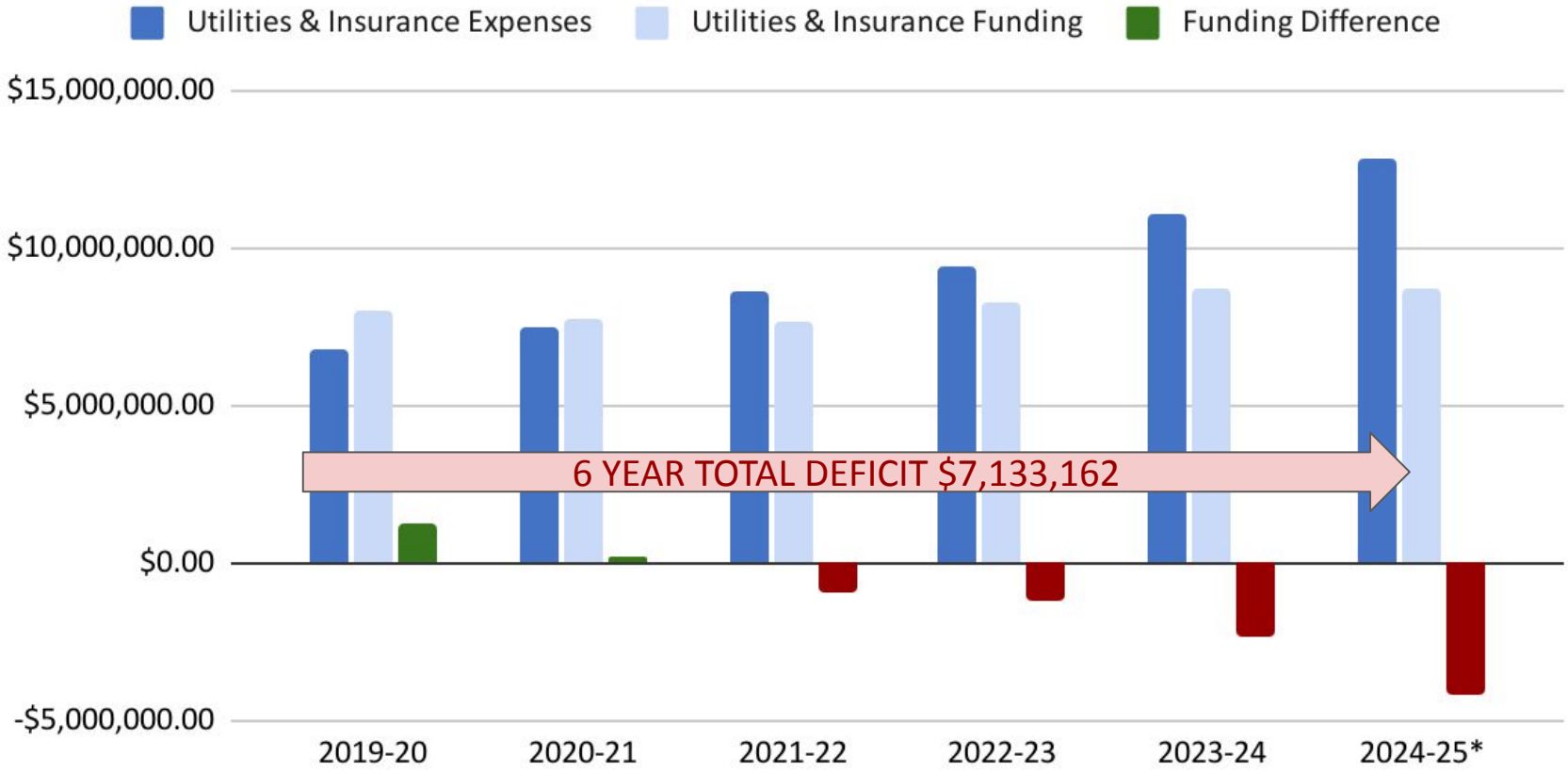
VPS: Special Education Expenses, Special Education State & Federal Funding and Funding Gap



* 2024-25 Based on Budget Data Since Actual TBD

	Special Education Expenses	Special Education State & Federal Funding	Funding Difference
2019-20	$46,273,540.00	$45,127,003.00	-$1,146,537.00
2020-21	$45,373,056.00	$43,495,999.00	-$1,877,057.00
2021-22	$49,902,599.00	$44,953,777.00	-$4,948,822.00
2022-23	$61,433,015.00	$49,089,266.00	-$12,343,749.00
2023-24	$69,554,613.00	$58,933,330.00	-$10,621,283.00
2024-25*	$76,092,981.00	$63,108,398.00	-$12,984,583.00

VPS: Utilities & Insurance Expenses, Utilities & Insurance Funding and Funding Difference



* 2024-25 Based on Budget Data Since Actual TBD

	Utilities & Insurance Expenses	Utilities & Insurance Funding	Funding Gap
2019-20	$6,758,381.83	$8,052,873.85	$1,294,492.02
2020-21	$7,490,293.23	$7,719,734.61	$229,441.38
2021-22	$8,600,036.84	$7,655,162.78	-$944,874.06
2022-23	$9,452,050.03	$8,235,124.56	-$1,216,925.47
2023-24	$11,095,933.88	$8,744,174.51	-$2,351,759.37
2024-25*	$12,856,251.00	$8,712,714.30	-$4,143,536.70

Next Steps

Advocacy - Special Education funding & non staffing costs (insurance & utilities)

6 year trends

- Special Education -$43,922,031
- Insurance/Utilities -$7,133,162

-$51,055,193

Next Steps

Advocacy - Special Education funding & non staffing costs (insurance & utilities)

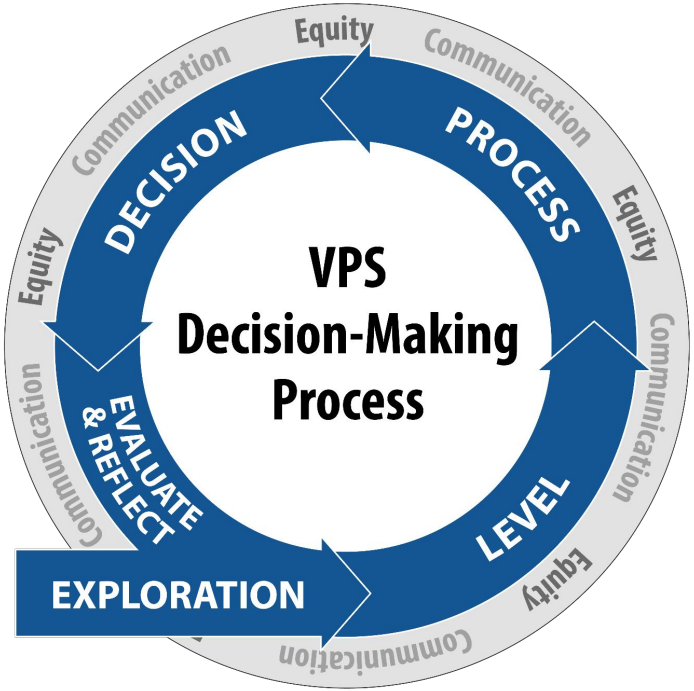
- Senate budget bill at least recognized and made meaningful investments in Spec. Ed. and MSOC.
- House budget bill totally neglected MSOC underfunding and made nominal commitments to Spec. Ed.
- If ‘Special’ legislative session required to negotiate final state budget, the district will have to begin staffing work for 25-26 based on conservative revenue assumptions

Next Steps

Current State of 25-26 Budget Planning

- With only the House budget's investments in underfunded costs, scope of reductions would be approx. 2% (compared to 9% in 24-25).
- Unlike last spring, no formal Reduction In Force (RIF) process for certificated positions would be necessary. Any required reductions would be achieved through normal attrition/reductions.

2025-26 Budget Development Process



Exploration

Level

Process

Decision (no reduction in force, Aug 2025)

Evaluate and Reflect

English

Issues at the Core of Washington State's School Funding Dilemma

LINK

A declining state priority. Increased student needs. Rising costs. Unfunded requirements.

These core issues are causing countless school districts across Washington to experience a financial crisis. The state of Washington is constitutionally responsible for fully funding the costs of basic education but even after reforms (the McCleary "Solution"), the state's efforts aren't keeping up with actual expenses.

VIEW VIDEOS

The state's school funding formula is the core issue.

State leaders use a funding distribution "formula" that's based on the needs of an "average school." This one-size-fits-some solution for allocating state money to schools isn't working because it doesn't recognize the unique needs and costs of

Employee Excellence Awards

Grace Borowski

Mental Health Therapist

Thomas Jefferson Middle School

Tyley Hunter

5th-Grade Teacher

Hazel Dell Elementary

Luanna Ingram

Math Teacher

Fort Vancouver High School

Student and Staff Recognitions

VANCOUVER PUBLIC SCHOOLS

Washington's 2024/25 District Director/Administrator Award

Dr. Brian Mathieson

Assistant Director of Career/College Readiness

VANCOUVER PUBLIC SCHOOLS VPS

Presidential Awards for Excellence in Mathematics and Science Teaching

WASHINGTON STATE FINALIST

Dr. Erin Lark

Science Teacher at Skyview

PRESIDENTIAL AWARDS FOR EXCELLENCE IN MATHEMATICS AND SCIENCE TEACHING

National Center for Women & Information Technology

REGIONAL WINNERS

Eyleen Cervera-Bohon
Adele Meyer
Suki Mohammadi
Kim Pham

REGIONAL RISING STAR

Yue-Lin Chen

REGIONAL HONORABLE MENTIONS

Della Hamideh
Paige Hill

Washington State Family, Career, and Community Leaders of America

REGIONAL COMPETITION - Columbia River

Gold Medal

Emily Shawver

Leona Lee

Washington State Family, Career, Community Leaders of America

REGIONAL COMPETITION - Hudson's Bay

Gold Medal

Sabriya Folsom
Sloan Casanova
Aishling Rauen

Silver Medal

Samantha Crawford

Future Farmers of America

WASHINGTON STATE COMPETITION

Team *Bay Gold* - *STATE CHAMPS!*

Hope Coonradt, Nova Benson, Helene Repman, Gracie Dietrich and Alice Huskins

Team *Bay Black* - *4th Place*

Anthony Gonzalez, Sydd Huff, Val Ramos, Jessyka Malone

Top 5 Individual Competition

Alice Huskins – *STATE CHAMP!*

Nova Benson – *3rd*

Hope Coonradt – *4th*

Anthony Gonzalez – *5th*

Name Change Consideration

- 2023-24 to current year
- A series of engagements with students, staff, families, and community to:
  - Review history of name
  - Discussion about if the history of the namesake reflects the values of the school
- Report summary of those discussions to the School Board - Spring 2024
- Follow naming guidelines from Procedure 6970P
- Determine top three to five names to submit to superintendent and school board for consideration and final decision
  - School team engagement
  - Review
  - Survey

Harney Elementary

1. Edgewood Elementary
2. Esperanza Elementary
3. Bridges Elementary
4. Vancouver School of Hope
5. Freedom Elementary

Harney Elementary

1. **Edgewood Elementary** — This name was chosen because it puts focus on the beautiful, little known, Edgewood neighborhood in which our school resides. Ours is a community school. We are a family. This name represents that and honors our neighborhood. This option rated the highest with our community and staff and in the top 5 with our students.

2. **Esperanza Elementary** — This name reflects the values we have that all students have the ability to succeed and brings an important community piece. Esperanza means hope in Spanish. This is an important quality to possess in many aspects of life. It brings in the value of our school that all students can achieve. Esperanza is what is given when all students, staff, and neighborhood families all work together for the success of the students. This option was rated the second choice of our community and the third choice for students, but the staff did not rate this in the top 3 as many have stated the name Esperanza might discount our English classes. They feel that it would put all the emphasis on the Spanish, and they feel Edgewood would be more inclusive.

Harney Elementary

3. **Bridges Elementary** — This name symbolizes how bilingual education connects cultures and communities. This name honors its status as the first public school in the state while emphasizing its bilingual program. We are also geographically near 2 interstate bridges. The metaphor of a “bridge” provides teachers and staff significant opportunities for teaching social-emotional skills, cultural competence, tolerance, and equity. This option rated second with the staff, third with the community and fourth with students.
4. **Vancouver School of Hope** — “Vancouver” maintains important historical and local relevance, “Hope” demonstrates that all students have potential to achieve and do something special, adding Vancouver in the name helps link VITA and VSAA with our school, showing a more connected community in this corner of the city of Vancouver. This option rated the top choice with students, but not in the top 5 of community or staff.
5. **Freedom Elementary** — One of the themes from our student suggestion is that freedom is the opposite of oppression, which Gen. Harney did a lot. This option rated second with students, but not in the top 5 of community or staff.

Peter S. Ogden Elementary

1. Ogden Elementary
2. Ogden Meadows Elementary
3. Rosa Parks Elementary
4. Sequoia Elementary
5. Horizon Elementary

Peter S. Ogden Elementary

1. **Ogden Elementary** — During the 2023-2024 school year, over 75% of everyone we talked to wanted to drop Peter S, but remain Ogden Elementary. This matched the community's work in 2019 when they decided not to put Peter S. on any signage when the school moved into the new building. This was also the overwhelming theme from the name suggestions and how the staff, students, and community rated the different names.

   One community member stated: “While the name Peter S. Ogden does not represent our core values, the name Ogden does because it is the name of the neighborhood that the school serves. Ogden Elementary reflects that Ogden is a true community school.” One staff member stated: “The name Ogden has become a word that represents the community that we love deeply. Especially over the last several years, our Ogden team has rallied together to endure so many trials. Through them all we bore the name of our school with pride, not because of the man, but because of the people.”

2. **Ogden Meadows Elementary** — This was the original name of the school when it opened in 1944 as a junior high school. It was then converted into a senior high school but was burned to the ground by arson in 1948. The school was reopened in 1955 as Peter S. Ogden Elementary, but that school was destroyed by a tornado in 1972. Ogden Meadows represents the resiliency of the school and the community.

Peter S. Ogden Elementary

3. **Rosa Parks Elementary** — Rosa Parks was the second most suggested name after Ogden. Almost all of the people who suggested the name stated that Rosa Parks represents the values of our community and was a model citizen that our students can aspire to be like.

4. **Sequoia Elementary** — One of the themes from our community responses was around Native American Identity, and Sequoia came in the top 5 ratings for staff, community, and students. One community member stated, “I like the Native American names to honor the heritage and because of the history of the Peter S Ogden name”

5. **Horizon Elementary** — Horizon was consistently rated in the top 5 names among staff, community and students. One community member stated, “this name means to represent the boundary of the known and the unknown, or the background of experience. And…is really bright and colorful and pretty and it represents the kids that attend this school.”